

SCHOOL OF LIFE FOUNDATION

The Architecture of *Grace*

Anchor Charts — Book 3 · The Interior

The complete set of classroom display charts for Grades 6–8 — print on cardstock or 11×17, post all year. Twenty-one charts carrying the program's four ideas through the inner work of early adolescence.

What's in This Pack

Twenty-one display charts, transcribed directly from the curriculum. Many are built with the class at the moment their lesson indicates; several are marked in the curriculum as permanent — keep them posted all year.

Mask vs. Mirror	IDENTITY	Three Sides of Every Story	REPAIR
Signal vs. Noise	IDENTITY	The Digital Backpack	WELL-BEING
Label vs. Integrity	IDENTITY	Forgiveness vs. Reconciliation	FORGIVENESS
The Choice-Agency Map	AGENCY	Flame vs. Pause	GRACE
Shame vs. Guilt	SELF-COMPASSION	The Pause	GRACE
The Internal Critic	SELF-COMPASSION	Limits — The Boundary Formula	GRACE
Highlight Reel vs. Blooper Reel	SELF-COMPASSION	What Is Grace?	GRACE
The Perfectionism Spectrum	SELF-COMPASSION	Mercy	GRACE
The Friend Test	SELF-COMPASSION	The Micro-Moment Menu	GRACE
Accountability vs. Self-Punishment	REPAIR	Difficult vs. Unsafe	SAFETY
Impact vs. Intent	REPAIR		

Mask vs. Mirror

Unit 1 · Lesson 1

IDENTITY

THE MASK

- What I show others
- What I perform
- What I hide
- What I emphasise

THE MIRROR

- What is actually there when the performance stops
- My real opinions
- My actual struggles
- What I value

The gap between these two is where the cost lives.

Signal vs. Noise

Unit 1 · The Volume of Integrity

IDENTITY

SIGNAL

- Integrity — the consistent, quiet voice of your values

NOISE

- Peer pressure — loud, surrounding, hard to hear past
- Social proof
- Fear of exclusion
- Identity merger

What makes the noise louder? Name it — and you can hear past it.

Label vs. Integrity

Unit 1 · Author of Your Story

IDENTITY

LABEL

- Something others assign from the outside
- Based on social dynamics, past incidents, reputation, rumour

INTEGRITY STATEMENT

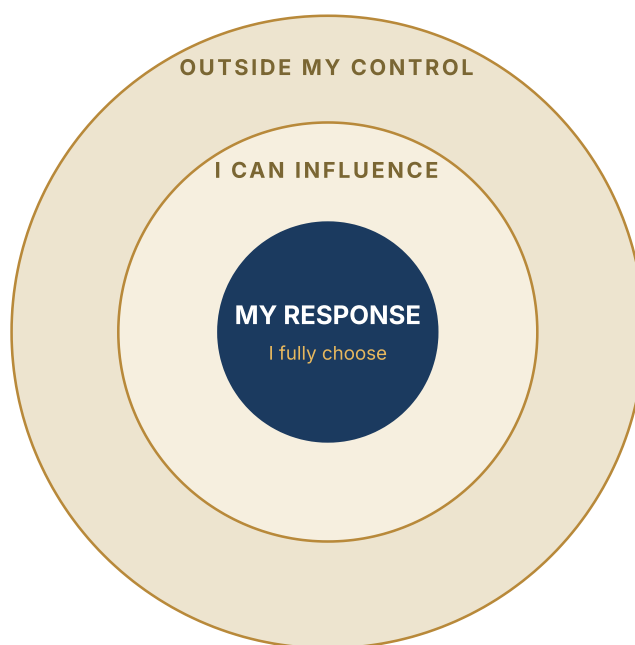
- Something you claim from the inside
- Based on your values, your choices, your authorship

Who gets to write your story?

The Choice-Agency Map

Unit 1 · Three Concentric Circles

AGENCY



Outer: Things completely outside my control.

Middle: Things I can influence but not control.

Inner: Things I can fully choose — starting with my own response.

“My response” always belongs in the inner circle.

Shame vs. Guilt

Unit 2

SELF-COMPASSION

SHAME

- "I AM bad."
- Produces hiding, withdrawal, defensiveness, aggression
- Focuses on self
- Almost never produces growth or repair

GUILT

- "I DID something that didn't fit who I want to be."
- Produces discomfort directed toward repair
- Functional and forward-moving

Shame says "I am bad." Guilt says "I did something." Only one points toward repair.

The Internal Critic

Unit 2 · Three Tactics

SELF-COMPASSION

CATASTROPHISING

“Everything is ruined. This is the worst thing that has ever happened.”

GLOBALISING

“I always fail. I never get it right. I am just bad at this.”

PERSONALISING

“Everything that went wrong is my fault.”

THE COMPASSIONATE WITNESS

Honest + Fair + Kind. Not a cheerleader. Not a critic in disguise.

Name the tactic, and the voice loses its disguise.

Highlight Reel vs. Blooper Reel

Unit 2

SELF-COMPASSION

HIGHLIGHT REEL

- The curated, filtered, best-of presentation
- What others see of us — and what we see of others online

BLOOPER REEL

- The full, unedited experience
- The hard moments, doubts, failures, and ordinary days

You are comparing your blooper reel to someone else's highlight reel.

The Perfectionism Spectrum

Unit 2

SELF-COMPASSION

PERFECTIONISM

“Failure = I am worthless.” Terror masquerading as ambition.

HEALTHY STRIVING

“Failure = data I can learn from.” High standards without self-destruction.

What is the fear underneath the left side?

The Friend Test

Unit 2

SELF-COMPASSION

TO MY BEST FRIEND

- What I would say to my best friend in this situation

TO MYSELF

- What I actually say to myself in this situation

The skill you already have is empathy toward friends. We are redirecting it toward yourself.

Accountability vs. Self-Punishment

Unit 3

REPAIR

ACCOUNTABILITY

- "I made a choice that didn't fit who I want to be. What do I need to do?"
- Forward motion
- Produces repair

SELF-PUNISHMENT

- "I am bad. I will suffer."
- Focuses on self
- Produces nothing useful

Feeling bad is not the same as taking responsibility. Action is.

Impact vs. Intent

Unit 3

REPAIR

INTENT

- What was in the mind of the person who acted

IMPACT

- What was experienced by the person who was affected

Both are real. Only one determines what repair addresses.

Three Sides of Every Story

Unit 3

REPAIR

POINT 1 · YOUR SIDE

What you experienced, felt, needed.

POINT 2 · THEIR SIDE

What they experienced, felt, needed.

POINT 3 · THE COMPASSIONATE OBSERVER

Someone who cares about both people and sees what neither can from where they stand.

The third side is the hardest — and the most important.

The Digital Backpack

Unit 1

WELL-BEING

Posts

Comments

Likes

Shares

Screenshots

Messages

Once it's in, it stays — mostly permanent, potentially public,
and it carries longer than you intended.

For students without digital access, the same is true of in-person presence.

Forgiveness vs. Reconciliation

Unit 3

FORGIVENESS

FORGIVENESS

- Internal psychological process
- Choosing to release resentment — for your own sake, not theirs

RECONCILIATION

- The restoration of a relationship
- A separate, external decision

These are two separate things. You can have one without the other.

Flame vs. Pause

GRACE

Unit 3 · React vs. Respond

FLAME · React

- Feeding the fire
- Fast
- Emotion-driven
- Makes it worse

PAUSE · Respond

- "What do I actually want to happen here?"
- Slower
- Chosen
- Opens a way through

Flame feeds the fire. Pause asks what you actually want to happen.

The Pause

Unit 3 · Four-Step Sequence

GRACE

- 1 Stop**
Before sending, posting, or responding.
- 2 Ask**
What do I actually want to happen here?
- 3 Consider**
What will this action cause?
- 4 Choose**
The minimum effective response — or disengage entirely.

Step 0 — Charitable Interpretation: assume the kindest plausible reason first.

Limits — The Boundary Formula

Unit 4

GRACE

THE BOUNDARY FORMULA

When you ____, I ____ . Going forward, I need ____ .

A limit is information about what you need to be okay — not a punishment, and not a demand that the other person change.

What Is Grace?

Unit 4

GRACE

“Grace is the deliberate choice to extend something generous to someone who has not necessarily earned it.”

Grace is not sentimentality. It is chosen strength.

Mercy

Unit 4 · Definition and Tension

GRACE

“Mercy is restraining power you could legitimately use — not because the consequence isn’t deserved, but because something more important than being right is at stake: the person’s capacity to grow.”

The mercy–justice tension is real. This lesson does not resolve it.

The Micro-Moment Menu

GRACE

Unit 4 · Specific Grace Acts

- + Say the name of the person you sit next to when you greet them.

- + Acknowledge someone's contribution in a group before adding your own.

- + Make eye contact and nod when someone is speaking.

- + Notice when someone is left out and move toward them.

- + Let someone go first in a situation where you could have gone first.

Specificity is the key requirement — pick one, and do it.

Difficult vs. Unsafe

Unit 4 · Visual Spectrum

SAFETY

EASY

Someone you like,
someone who has been
kind to you.

DIFFICULT

Irritating, challenging,
hard to be around. Grace
is appropriate and
possible.

UNSAFE

Active harm, ongoing
danger. Safety is the
priority — grace is not
the goal here.

The distinction between difficult and unsafe changes everything.